

BLK II - UNIT 5: METOC Mission Products

b. 5-Day Forecast

Introduction to the 5-Day Forecast

The purpose of the 5-Day forecast is to provide a basic weather outlook to the customer. This product is used for planning purposes only but often serves as a great tool for commanders and base personnel to plan future events. The goal is to create a product that is as accurate as possible with the understanding that the further out the forecast is, the more variables can change. Proper forecasting techniques are also important as this will help lead to accuracy for the entire forecast period.

5-Day Forecast Formatting

The 5-Day format is very similar to civilian products you may have seen before on the local news channel or weather apps. This product is a picture-based and will include these elements: expected weather, sky condition, visibility, temperature, wind, and stoplight charts to communicate mission conditions. Each day of the forecast is broken into 12-hour blocks for a total of 10 sections of information included on the 5-day. Use the following information when creating and briefing the 5-day forecast.

Present Weather: Select the predominant type of weather expected throughout the 12-hour window, or select the worst weather expected.

Sky Condition: Report the predominant sky condition for the 12-hour period to include the amount of coverage, and the bases of clouds. If your sky condition for the time is Clear – Scattered, you do not need to include the height of clouds. Bases are only reported with Broken – Overcast skies. Use the following verbiage on the 5-day to convey sky cover.

- Clear: CLR
- Partly Cloudy: FEW-SCT
- Mostly Cloudy: BKN
- Overcast: BKN-OVC

Visibility: Report the predominant visibility in statute miles with 10 representing unrestricted visibility. Remember that if you have any restriction to visibility, you must have present weather reported. If you have visibility restrictions in one of the blocks, report the lowest expected visibility.

Temperature: You will report the highest and lowest temperatures in Fahrenheit for the entire 24-hour period. This is the only part of the 5-day that is not broken up into 12-hour blocks.

Wind: Report the predominant wind speed and direction for every 6-hours. Include a Gust if applicable. Remember to round your wind direction to the nearest 10 degrees. For training purposes, round your wind speeds to the nearest 5KT.

